Stop Building Ideas Nobody Wants

The Signal Test Method: A 30-Day Side Hustle Workbook to Test Demand Before You Build

By The Modern Family Guide

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Before You Build Anything

Most ideas do not fail because people are lazy.

They fail because nobody tested demand early enough.

This workbook forces you to do the opposite.

In the next 30 days, you will talk to real people, test a real problem, make a tiny offer, and ask for real money.

If nobody pays, you stop or pivot.

If someone pays, you continue.

That is the entire game.

Most people don't fail because they're lazy.

They fail because they never ask anyone if the idea is worth paying for.

This workbook forces you to ask.

Your First Win (15 Minutes)

Send this message to 1 person today

Hey, quick question — are you still struggling with [problem]?

If they reply, you have your first signal.

Don't overthink it.

Who will you message?

What Counts as a Real Signal?

Real signals

- Someone asks a follow-up question
- Someone shares a real problem
- Someone asks for the price
- Someone says “can you do this for me?”

Not real signals

- “Cool idea”
- “Nice”
- Likes
- Silence

If you cannot tell the difference, you will waste months building the wrong thing.

Workbook Roadmap

The Method

Conversion Tools

Start Here: 15-Minute Tests

Copy/Paste Scripts

Digital Side Hustle Case Study

30-Day Signal Plan

Signal Test Logs

Weekly Reviews

Signal Tracker

Stop / Pivot / Continue Decision

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook is not for collecting ideas. It is for testing whether an idea deserves more time. Each day asks you to take one small action, face the realistic friction, and record what actually happened.

Use this for

You'll learn to test your side hustle ideas in 30 days or less. Stop wasting time building products nobody wants to buy.

Your notes

The Method

Do not build first. Look for signals first.

Find a real problem

Identify something specific people complain about, struggle with daily, or find genuinely frustrating. It's more than an annoyance.

Test: Can you find 10 people in 2 hours who talk about this problem unprompted in online communities or conversations?

What goes wrong: You think something is a problem, but nobody else really cares enough to solve it. Or you pick a problem that's too small or rare.

Stop when: You can clearly state the problem and have seen at least 5 different people mention it publicly or directly as a pain point.

Your notes

Find someone who cares

Locate specific individuals who experience this problem often, are actively looking for solutions, or are deeply frustrated by it.

Test: Can you find 5 people who have tried to solve this problem themselves, spent money on a partial solution, or asked for help with it?

What goes wrong: You find people who have the problem, but they don't care enough to do anything about it. They just live with it, or it's not a priority.

Stop when: You have identified at least 3 people who seem genuinely frustrated by the problem and are open to discussing it with you.

Your notes

Make a tiny offer

Offer a very small, simple, and free (or very cheap) piece of advice, a mini-solution, or a resource directly related to their problem. This is not your final product.

Test: Can you make a tiny offer to 3 different people and get at least one 'yes' or clear expression of interest?

What goes wrong: Your offer isn't tiny enough, or it doesn't directly address their specific pain point. People ignore it, or politely decline.

Stop when: You have refined your tiny offer based on feedback and have a clear, simple statement that resonates with a few people, leading to acceptance.

Your notes

Ask directly

Once you have a tiny offer and some interest, ask them if they would be willing to pay for a more complete, but still simple, solution.

Test: Ask 3 people directly if they would pay for your idea for a minimal solution. Do you get any clear 'yes' or strong 'maybe, tell me more' signals?

What goes wrong: People say your tiny offer was nice, but they don't want to pay for more. They say 'that's interesting' but don't commit. Or they stop replying.

Stop when: You have a clear understanding of whether people would open their wallet for a solution, even if it's just a few positive signals, or consistently negative ones.

Your notes

Try to get paid

Ask for money or a clear commitment to pay for your minimal solution. This is the ultimate signal of real demand.

Test: Can you get a deposit, a pre-order, or an agreement to pay for your basic solution from at least one person?

What goes wrong: People back out. They say they'll pay later but don't. You get ghosted. It feels awkward and you avoid asking clearly.

Stop when: You have either collected payment from at least one person or received clear, consistent 'no' signals that tell you to pivot or stop this idea.

Your notes

Conversion Tools

These tools help you avoid the most common beginner mistake: confusing polite interest with real demand.

The 10-Message Test

Send 10 direct, personal messages before judging an idea. Don't count likes, compliments, or vague interest. Count replies that show pain or willingness to act.

Notes

The $10 Tiny Offer Test

Turn your idea into one small thing someone could buy for around $10. If nobody wants the tiny version, don't build the big version yet.

Notes

The Polite Interest Trap

People saying 'cool idea' is not demand. Demand looks like questions, urgency, payment, referrals, or asking when it's available.

Notes

The Silence Rule

If people ignore the offer after multiple direct asks, treat silence as data. Don't argue with the market.

Notes

The 3-Signal Scorecard

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Start Here: 15-Minute Tests

Find 3 problem forums

Identify three active online communities (Reddit, Facebook groups, LinkedIn groups, niche forums) where your target audience complains about problems related to your idea.

Your notes

Draft 5 tiny offers

Write five different short sentences describing a very simple, free solution (e.g., a one-page checklist, a useful tip, a brief explanation) to a problem you've observed.

Your notes

Contact 10 strangers

Reach out to 10 people in your target audience via direct message or email and ask them about their biggest challenge related to your idea. Focus on learning, not selling.

Your notes

Copy/Paste Scripts

Use these as starting points. Rewrite them so they sound like you.

Initial problem outreach

Hey [Name], I noticed your comment about [specific problem] in [Group/Forum]. I'm trying to understand that better. What's the most frustrating part of that for you, or what have you tried so far to fix it?

Notes

Follow-up on interest

Thanks for sharing, [Name]. It sounds really annoying. I'm thinking about putting together a simple [template/checklist/guide] to help with [specific aspect of problem]. It's just an idea, but would something like that be useful at all?

Notes

Introducing the tiny offer

Based on what we talked about regarding [problem], I actually made a super basic [mini-solution, e.g., 5-step checklist] that might help. It's free, no strings attached. Want me to send it over?

Notes

Asking for payment (soft)

Hey [Name], I'm getting some good feedback on the [mini-solution] I shared. I'm considering building a more complete version that does [X, Y, Z] to really solve [problem]. If I built that for $[price], would that be something you'd be interested in buying?

Notes

Asking for payment (direct)

Hi [Name], I'm ready to build out [product idea] to solve [problem] completely. I'm taking pre-orders for $[price] for early access. If you're serious about solving this, this is the best way to get it. Let me know if you want in.

Notes

Handling low interest/ghosting

Just checking in, [Name]. I haven't heard back about [previous message or offer]. No worries at all if it's not a fit right now, just wanted to close the loop. Good luck with [their problem].

Notes

Digital Side Hustle Case Study: The ‘Better Meeting Notes’ Template

Idea

A Notion template for project managers to create more actionable meeting notes and improve follow-ups.

What I did

Observed project managers in LinkedIn groups complaining about wasted meeting time, unclear action items, and poor follow-ups after meetings. Created a simple, 1-page Notion template for meeting notes focused on clear action items, decisions, and responsible parties. Offered the free template in a few LinkedIn groups, asking for feedback on whether it helped with their meeting note struggles.

What happened

Got 15 downloads of the free template. Only 3 people gave feedback, mostly vague ‘it’s okay, thanks’ comments. One person said it was ‘helpful but still missing X’. When I tried offering a ‘Pro’ version for $5 with more features to the 3 who gave feedback, I got zero takers. I also sent direct messages to 10 more project managers who had complained about meeting notes, offering the free template and asking if they’d pay for a more advanced version. I received no replies from 7, ‘not now’ from 2, and one ‘maybe’ that never turned into anything. The person who said ‘helpful but missing X’ later told me they just built their own more advanced version based on my template idea, indicating my solution wasn’t hitting a strong enough paid need.

What I learned

The problem (bad meeting notes) was real, but my specific template solution and pricing didn’t hit a strong enough pain point for people to pay. The free version was mildly useful, but it didn’t solve a severe enough pain or offer enough unique value for them to open their wallets, even at a low price.

Nobody bought the first version. That was the signal. Not failure.

What I would do differently

Instead of a template, I should have offered a 'Meeting Note Audit' service first. I could have charged $25 to review their current meeting note process and suggest personalized improvements, then perhaps offered a custom template as an upsell. This would have helped me understand their *actual* paid needs and priorities better by solving a problem with my time, not just a static product.

Your notes

30-Day Signal Plan

Each day has one action, one reality check, and one win condition. Complete the action before reading ahead.

Day 1: Brainstorm problems you've seen

Action

List 5 problems you or people you know complain about regularly. Think about things that are annoying, time-consuming, or frustrating in daily life or work.

Reality

It's harder than you think to identify a *real* problem with emotional weight versus a minor annoyance. Be honest.

Win condition

You have 5 distinct problems written down, each feeling like a genuine pain point.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 2: Validate problems with quick searches

Action

Search online forums, Reddit, Facebook groups, or LinkedIn for discussions related to your 5 problems. Look for complaints, questions, or frustration keywords.

Reality

Some problems might get zero mentions. Others might be very niche. Don't be discouraged by silence, it's a signal.

Win condition

You found at least 10 mentions of *any* of your problems across different platforms, showing others care.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 3: Pick your top 2 problems

Action

From your list, choose the two problems that seem to have the most online discussion, genuine frustration, and people actively seeking solutions or complaining often.

Reality

You might be tempted to pick a problem you *want* to solve, not one that's talked about. Stick to the data.

Win condition

You have narrowed down to 2 strong problem candidates, supported by public discussion.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 4: Define the target audience

Action

For your top 2 problems, describe *who* experiences this problem. Be specific: age, job, interests, online hangouts. What are their goals?

Reality

It's easy to be too vague ('everyone'). Aim for a clearer picture of a specific person or role.

Win condition

You have a brief profile (2-3 sentences) for the person who has each problem, including where they 'live' online.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 5: Find where they hang out

Action

List 3-5 specific online communities, forums, or groups where your target audience for *one* problem (pick your best one now) spends their time.

Reality

You might find groups, but they're inactive or not discussing problems relevant to you. Keep searching for active ones.

Win condition

You have 3 active online spots where your target audience congregates and discusses related topics.

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 6: Observe and listen

Action

Spend 1-2 hours observing discussions in your chosen communities. Look for keywords, frustrations, questions, and attempts to solve the problem. Don't post yet.

Reality

It's boring to just watch. You'll want to jump in. Resist the urge; just collect data.

Win condition

You have 5 specific quotes or complaints from different people about your chosen problem, revealing their exact language.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 7: Refine your problem statement

Action

Based on your observations, write a concise, direct statement of the problem your target audience faces. Make it impactful and specific to their pain.

Reality

Your initial problem statement might be too broad or too specific. It should clearly resonate with what you observed.

Win condition

You have a 1-sentence problem statement that clearly describes the core pain point you observed, using their language.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 8: Identify potential ‘carers’

Action

Go back to your chosen communities. Identify 5-10 people who seem to be most vocal about the problem, or have tried to solve it themselves. Note their names/usernames.

Reality

Many people complain, but few show signs of actively caring enough to seek solutions or put in effort. Focus on the active ones.

Win condition

You have a list of 5 potential ‘carers’ who show high engagement with the problem and a desire for a solution.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 9: First low-stakes outreach

Action

Send a simple, non-salesy message (use Script 1) to 3 of your identified ‘carers’. Just ask for more details about their specific problem.

Reality

You’ll likely get few or no replies. It feels like you’re bothering people. This is normal. Learn from the silence.

Win condition

You sent 3 messages to potential carers, initiating contact.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 10: Follow-up (if needed) and observe more

Action

If no replies, send a gentle follow-up (Script 6, modified for no reply). Otherwise, continue observing communities for more ‘carers’ and subtle cues about their pain.

Reality

Ghosting is common. Don’t take it personally. It’s not a rejection of you, but of the perceived value of replying.

Win condition

You’ve either engaged in a brief exchange with someone or identified 2 more potential carers based on renewed observation.

You’re not looking for motivation. You’re looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 11: Identify 3 deeper pain points

Action

From your observations and any replies, list 3 specific sub-problems or frustrations related to your main problem. These should be granular and actionable.

Reality

People might give vague answers. You have to read between the lines and infer deeper issues.

Win condition

You have 3 clear, actionable sub-pain points that could be addressed by a small solution.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 12: Brainstorm tiny solutions for 1 pain point

Action

For ONE of your deeper pain points, brainstorm 3 very small, simple, free solutions. (e.g., a 1-page PDF, a 3-step checklist, a single paragraph of advice).

Reality

You'll want to build a whole product. Stop yourself. Make it truly tiny and focused on delivering immediate, minor relief.

Win condition

You have 3 ultra-simple solution ideas for one specific sub-problem, ready to be created quickly.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 13: Draft 3 tiny offers

Action

Based on your tiny solutions, write 3 short, direct ‘tiny offer’ statements (use Script 3 adapted) to share with potential ‘carers’. Make them clear and low-commitment.

Reality

Crafting a clear, compelling tiny offer is hard. It might sound too vague or too big. Practice clarity.

Win condition

You have 3 distinct tiny offer statements ready to use, each describing a quick win for the user.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 14: Prepare for the offer

Action

Choose your best tiny offer. Get ready to actually deliver it. If it's a simple document, draft it now. Make sure it's polished and easy to send.

Reality

You might procrastinate on actually creating the tiny thing. It needs to be real, even if small.

Win condition

Your chosen tiny offer (e.g., a PDF, text advice, a link) is created and ready to send instantly.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 15: Deliver first tiny offer

Action

Reach out to 2-3 of your ‘carers’ (or new ones you’ve identified) and make your tiny offer (use Script 3). Be genuine and clear about its free nature.

Reality

Even for a free offer, some people won’t reply or will decline. It feels like rejection, but it’s just data.

Win condition

You’ve sent out your tiny offer to at least 2 people who previously showed interest in the problem.

You’re not looking for motivation. You’re looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 16: Gather initial feedback on tiny offer

Action

If anyone accepts, send the tiny offer. After a day or two, follow up and ask for their honest thoughts on its usefulness and if it helped at all.

Reality

People might say ‘it’s good’ without really meaning it, or they just don’t reply after getting it. Dig for specifics.

Win condition

You’ve sent a follow-up asking for feedback on your tiny offer from anyone who accepted it.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 17: Adjust tiny offer or pivot

Action

Based on any feedback (or lack thereof), decide if your tiny offer is hitting the mark. Refine it or choose a different tiny offer to test next.

Reality

You might be tempted to defend your idea instead of listening to signals. Be objective.

Win condition

You have a refined tiny offer or a new one prepared, based on user reception.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 18: Deliver second tiny offer

Action

Send your (possibly revised) tiny offer to 2-3 *new* ‘carers’ or people who seemed receptive previously. Cast a slightly wider net.

Reality

You might feel tired of repeating the process. This is the grind. Push through and look for consistent signals.

Win condition

You’ve sent out your revised or new tiny offer to at least 2 people, gathering more data.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 19: Identify willingness to pay (subtly)

Action

In conversations about your tiny offer, listen for any hints of ‘I wish this did X’ or ‘I’d pay for Y if…‘ Don’t ask directly for money yet, just listen.

Reality

People rarely volunteer payment ideas. You have to really listen for underlying frustrations that hint at a monetary solution.

Win condition

You have noted any subtle hints of a deeper, unaddressed need or desire for a more robust paid solution.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 20: Brainstorm next-level solution

Action

Based on successful tiny offers and feedback, brainstorm what a slightly more complete (paid) solution could look like. What would be the minimal viable product?

Reality

It's easy to over-engineer. Keep it simple – the *minimum* thing you could charge for that solves a more significant pain.

Win condition

You have a rough outline of a minimal paid solution (e.g., a detailed checklist, a simple template with instructions, a mini-course).

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 21: Ask directly: Soft approach

Action

To 2-3 people who showed interest in your tiny offer, use Script 4 to ask if they'd be interested in buying a more complete solution for a specific price.

Reality

It's nerve-wracking to ask for money. Expect 'maybe' or 'not right now'. This is where most ideas die.

Win condition

You've sent 2-3 soft payment inquiries to your most promising leads.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 22: Analyze soft responses

Action

Review responses from Day 21. Look for genuine interest versus polite deflection. Is there a common objection or reason for hesitation?

Reality

People are polite. ‘I’ll think about it’ usually means ‘no’. A clear objection is better than vague positivity.

Win condition

You’ve identified any patterns in the responses (or lack thereof), giving you insight into market resistance.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 23: Refine your paid offer description

Action

Based on feedback, refine what your minimal paid solution offers and how you describe it. Make sure it clearly addresses the pain point they expressed.

Reality

You might have to drastically simplify or even change your idea based on clear feedback. Be adaptable.

Win condition

You have a clear, refined description of your paid solution that directly speaks to their observed needs.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 24: Ask directly: More direct approach

Action

To 1-2 people who showed the *most* interest (or a new, highly engaged ‘carer’), use a slightly more direct approach (modified Script 5) to see if they’d commit. Don’t ask for money yet, just commitment.

Reality

This is where signals often die. People hesitate when commitment is involved. It takes courage to ask.

Win condition

You’ve made 1-2 direct commitment inquiries, pushing for a ‘yes’ or ‘no’.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 25: Evaluate commitment signals

Action

Assess responses from Day 24. Did anyone say ‘yes, I’d definitely buy that’ or similar? Or was it all hesitation and vague answers?

Reality

Positive signals are rare. Even ‘yes’ can turn into ‘no’ when actual money is involved. Be skeptical.

Win condition

You have a clear understanding of the level of verbal commitment you’re getting, or a clear lack thereof.

You’re not looking for motivation. You’re looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 26: Try to get paid: First attempt

Action

To the single *most* promising lead (if you have one), use Script 5 (or a version of it) to ask for payment, a deposit, or a pre-order.

Reality

This is the hardest step. You'll likely face silence or an outright 'no.' It feels personal, but it's just business.

Win condition

You have asked at least one person for money for your solution, taking the ultimate test.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 27: Handle ‘no’ or silence

Action

If you get a ‘no’ or no reply, send Script 6 (modified). Don’t burn bridges. Analyze *why* they said no if you got a reason.

Reality

It’s easy to get discouraged. Remember, a clear ‘no’ is better than a vague ‘maybe’ – it frees you up.

Win condition

You’ve respectfully handled any rejections or silences, gaining insights from them.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 28: Collect payment or pivot

Action

If you got a ‘yes’ on Day 26, process the payment! If not, take what you’ve learned. Is there another angle for the same problem, or do you need to pivot to a different problem entirely?

Reality

Few people make it to this step with actual money. Don’t build until you get paid, unless your goal is purely learning.

Win condition

You’ve either received payment for your idea or have a clear plan to pivot based on strong ‘no’ signals.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 29: Document learnings

Action

Write down everything you learned about your target audience, their problem, their willingness to pay, and what works/doesn't work in your outreach.

Reality

It's tempting to skip this when frustrated or excited. Don't. This is your most valuable asset.

Win condition

You have a summary of key insights, positive and negative, from your 30-day test.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 30: Decide next steps

Action

Based on your documented learnings, decide: A) Build the product for the person who paid. B) Re-test a modified offer for the same problem. C) Abandon this problem and start over with a new one.

Reality

This is where you make the tough call based on data, not hope. Trust the signals.

Win condition

You have a clear action plan for your next 30 days, knowing whether to build, refine, or move on.

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Signal Test Logs

Use these pages for extra tests, repeated asks, new audiences, and price checks.

Signal Test Log 1

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 2

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 3

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 4

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 5

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 6

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 7

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 8

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 9

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 10

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 11

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 12

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Extra Scorecards

Use one scorecard per idea, audience, or offer version.

Scorecard 1

3-Signal Scorecard 1

Problem strength (1-5): _____

Reachability (1-5): _____

Willingness to pay (1-5): _____

Total score: _____

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

_____
_____
_____
_____
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_____
_____

Scorecard 2

3-Signal Scorecard 2

Problem strength (1-5): _____

Reachability (1-5): _____

Willingness to pay (1-5): _____

Total score: _____

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

_____
_____
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_____
_____

Scorecard 3

3-Signal Scorecard 3

Problem strength (1-5): _____

Reachability (1-5): _____

Willingness to pay (1-5): _____

Total score: _____

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Scorecard 4

3-Signal Scorecard 4

Problem strength (1-5): _____

Reachability (1-5): _____

Willingness to pay (1-5): _____

Total score: _____

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Scorecard 5

3-Signal Scorecard 5

Problem strength (1-5): _____

Reachability (1-5): _____

Willingness to pay (1-5): _____

Total score: _____

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Scorecard 6

3-Signal Scorecard 6

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Scorecard 7

3-Signal Scorecard 7

Problem strength (1-5): _____

Reachability (1-5): _____

Willingness to pay (1-5): _____

Total score: _____

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Scorecard 8

3-Signal Scorecard 8

Problem strength (1-5): _____

Reachability (1-5): _____

Willingness to pay (1-5): _____

Total score: _____

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Weekly Reviews

These pages help you avoid confusing motion with progress.

Weekly Review 1

Strongest signal this week

What was the clearest sign that someone cared?

Your notes

Weakest signal this week

Where did you get silence, vague praise, or polite interest?

Notes

What changed

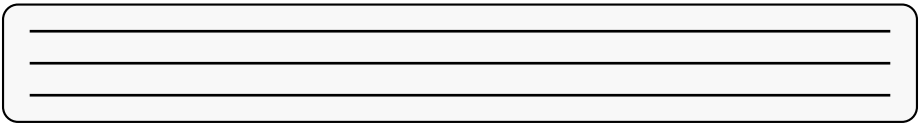
What did you change because of real feedback?

Notes

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Why?

Your notes



Weekly Review 2

Strongest signal this week

What was the clearest sign that someone cared?

Your notes

Weakest signal this week

Where did you get silence, vague praise, or polite interest?

Notes

What changed

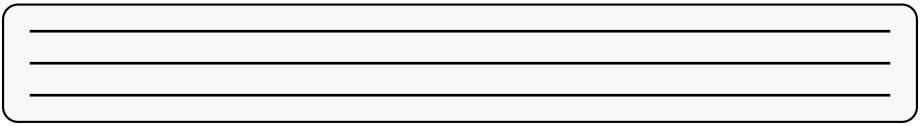
What did you change because of real feedback?

Notes

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Why?

Your notes



Weekly Review 3

Strongest signal this week

What was the clearest sign that someone cared?

Your notes

Weakest signal this week

Where did you get silence, vague praise, or polite interest?

Notes

What changed

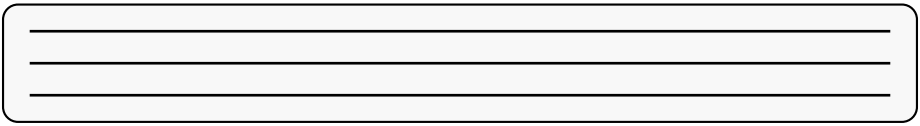
What did you change because of real feedback?

Notes

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Why?

Your notes



Weekly Review 4

Strongest signal this week

What was the clearest sign that someone cared?

Your notes

Weakest signal this week

Where did you get silence, vague praise, or polite interest?

Notes

What changed

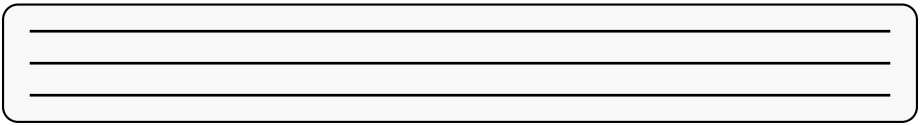
What did you change because of real feedback?

Notes

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Why?

Your notes



Price Test Notes

Price Test 1

What price did you ask for? Who did you ask? What happened?

Your notes

Price Test 2

What price did you ask for? Who did you ask? What happened?

Your notes

Price Test 3

What price did you ask for? Who did you ask? What happened?

Your notes

Price Test 4

What price did you ask for? Who did you ask? What happened?

Your notes

Signal Tracker

Date	Test	Signal	Next action

Stop / Pivot / Continue

Continue

What created a real signal: payment, specific request, repeated problem, urgency, or a direct yes?

Your notes

Pivot

What part seemed promising, but needs a different audience, offer, price, or message?

Notes

Stop

What produced silence, vague compliments, weak signals, or polite interest without action?

Notes

Next $10 Test

What is the smallest paid test you'll run next?

Your notes

Final Notes

What I learned about the market

What did real people show you?

Notes

What I learned about myself

What did you avoid, overthink, or discover?

Notes